ServiceNow Master Terminology Glossary

An extensive, student-friendly reference of ServiceNow terminology, abbreviations, platform concepts, administration, development, ITSM, Service Catalog, CMDB/CSDM, integrations, security, reporting, and major product areas.

Important scope note: ServiceNow contains hundreds of products, applications, and product-specific terms. This glossary is designed as a practical master reference rather than a claim to contain every term ever introduced in every ServiceNow release. Definitions are concise and independently worded for learning and training.

Total glossary entries in this edition: 598

Contents

1. 1. Platform & Core Concepts — 34 terms
2. 2. Data Model & Tables — 46 terms
3. 3. Navigation, Forms & UI — 30 terms
4. 4. Server-side Development & Scripting — 46 terms
5. 5. Security & Access Control — 23 terms
6. 6. ITSM — 41 terms
7. 7. Service Catalog — 22 terms
8. 8. Workflow, Flow Designer & Automation — 23 terms
9. 9. Notifications & Messaging — 11 terms
10. 10. Data Import & Migration — 17 terms
11. 11. Integration & APIs — 31 terms
12. 12. CMDB, CSDM & ITOM — 41 terms
13. 13. IT Asset Management — 21 terms
14. 14. Knowledge & Content — 12 terms
15. 15. Reporting & Analytics — 17 terms
16. 16. Update Sets & Deployment — 16 terms
17. 17. ServiceNow Architecture & System Concepts — 28 terms
18. 18. Service Portal & Employee Experience — 13 terms
19. 19. Customer Service Management — 17 terms
20. 20. HR Service Delivery — 11 terms
21. 21. Security Operations & GRC — 14 terms
22. 22. Project & Portfolio Management — 13 terms
23. 23. Common Abbreviations — 39 terms
24. 24. Important System Objects & Tables — 32 terms

1. 1. Platform & Core Concepts

Term	Meaning
ServiceNow	A cloud platform for building and running digital workflows and enterprise applications.
Now Platform	The underlying ServiceNow platform on which ServiceNow products and custom applications run.
Instance	A dedicated ServiceNow environment containing its own data, configuration, users, and applications.
PDI	Personal Developer Instance; a developer environment provided for learning and development.
Production instance	The live environment used by an organization for real business operations.
Sub-production instance	A non-production environment such as development, test, QA, or staging.
Development instance	Environment where developers build and configure changes.
Test instance	Environment used to verify configuration and application behavior.
Application	A collection of related tables, modules, logic, security, and user experiences for a business purpose.
Application scope	A boundary that controls ownership and visibility of application artifacts and data.
Scoped application	An application whose artifacts operate within a defined application scope.
Global scope	The traditional shared application scope available across the instance.
Module	A navigation item in the Application Navigator that opens a list, form, report, or function.
Application Navigator	The navigation area used to find applications and modules.
All menu	The area where users search or browse available applications and modules.
Favorites	Saved navigation items or pages for quick access.
Plugin	A packaged capability that can activate additional ServiceNow functionality.
Store application	An application distributed through the ServiceNow Store.
Application repository	A mechanism for managing and distributing applications between environments.
Release	A named version of the ServiceNow platform, with new features, fixes, and changes.
Upgrade	The process of moving an instance to a newer ServiceNow release.
Patch	A maintenance update containing fixes or targeted improvements.
Hotfix	A targeted fix for a specific issue.
OOTB	Out of the box; functionality delivered by ServiceNow without custom development.
Customization	A modification made beyond the standard delivered configuration.
Configuration	Changing platform behavior using supported configuration rather than custom code.
Technical debt	Future maintenance cost created by unnecessary complexity, customization, or shortcuts.
Now Experience	ServiceNow's modern user experience framework for building web experiences.
Workspace	A role-oriented interface that brings related records, tasks, and tools together.
UI Builder	A low-code tool for building and configuring modern ServiceNow experiences.
Page	A user-interface screen that contains components and data.
Component	A reusable UI element placed on a page.
Data resource	A reusable definition that supplies data to UI components.
Controller	A UI Builder mechanism that manages data or page behavior.

2. 2. Data Model & Tables

Term	Meaning
Table	A database structure that stores records in rows and fields in columns.

Term	Meaning
Record	One row of data in a ServiceNow table.
Field	A data element on a record; conceptually a database column.
Column	A database representation of a table field.
Dictionary	Metadata that defines tables, fields, data types, attributes, and behavior.
Dictionary entry	A metadata record describing a table or field.
Data type	The kind of data a field stores, such as string, integer, date, or reference.
String	A field type used to store text.
Integer	A numeric field type for whole numbers.
Decimal	A numeric field type that can store fractional values.
Boolean	A true/false field type.
Date	A field type storing a calendar date.
Date/Time	A field type storing both date and time.
Reference field	A field that points to a record in another table.
Choice field	A field whose value is selected from predefined choices.
List field	A field designed to hold multiple referenced records.
Journal field	A field designed for ongoing entries such as work notes or comments.
HTML field	A field that stores rich HTML-formatted content.
Attachment	A file associated with a record.
sys_id	A unique identifier assigned to a ServiceNow record.
Number	A human-readable identifier generated for many task-based records.
Display value	The value ServiceNow shows to users to represent a referenced record.
Display field	A field designated to represent a record when referenced.
Primary key	The unique identifier conceptually used to identify a record; ServiceNow commonly uses sys_id.
Parent table	A table from which another table inherits fields and behavior.
Child table	A table that extends another table and inherits its fields and behavior.
Table extension	The inheritance relationship in which one table extends another.
Base table	A higher-level table that provides common fields or behavior to child tables.
Task table	The base table used for many work-oriented records such as incidents and changes.
Incident table	The table storing incident records.
Problem table	The table storing problem records.
Change Request table	The table storing change records.
User table	The table that stores user records, commonly sys_user.
Group table	The table that stores groups, commonly sys_user_group.
Role table	The table that stores role definitions.
Many-to-many relationship	A relationship where records from two tables can be related to multiple records on the other side.
Many-to-many definition	Configuration defining a many-to-many relationship between tables.
Database view	A reporting structure that joins data from multiple tables.
Reference qualifier	A condition that controls which records are available in a reference field.
Dependent field	A field whose available values depend on another field.
Related list	A section on a form showing records related to the current record.
Form	The interface used to view or edit one record.
List	The interface used to display multiple records.

Term	Meaning
List layout	Configuration controlling which fields appear in a list.
Form layout	Configuration controlling fields and sections shown on a form.
View	A named arrangement of fields, sections, or lists for a particular use.

3. 3. Navigation, Forms & UI

Term	Meaning
Form section	A visual grouping of related fields on a form.
Form header	The upper area of a form containing record information and actions.
Form button	A button that performs an action on a record.
Form link	A link that performs an action or opens another location.
Context menu	A menu containing actions available for a list or form.
Breadcrumb	The navigation path showing the filters or list context used to reach a list.
Filter	A condition used to restrict records displayed in a list.
Encoded query	A compact string representation of ServiceNow filter conditions.
Condition builder	The UI used to create query conditions without manually writing encoded query syntax.
Sort	Ordering records by one or more fields.
Group by	Grouping list records by a selected field.
Personalize list	Changing list columns, order, sorting, or grouping for a user.
List edit	Editing field values directly from a list.
Cell edit	Changing a single field value inline in a list.
Contextual search	Search behavior that uses the current application or data context.
Global search	Search across supported ServiceNow content from a central search interface.
Related link	A link shown on a form for an associated action or record.
Formatter	A configurable form element that displays additional information or UI.
UI macro	A reusable piece of UI markup or behavior used in classic interfaces.
UI page	A custom page built using ServiceNow UI technologies.
UI script	Reusable client-side JavaScript for UI behavior.
UI action	A button, link, or menu action that performs a configured operation.
UI policy	A client-side configuration that controls field visibility, mandatory state, or read-only state.
Catalog UI policy	A UI policy specifically controlling variables on catalog forms.
Client script	Client-side JavaScript that runs in the browser for form behavior.
Catalog client script	Client-side JavaScript used on service catalog forms.
Client callable	A setting allowing an appropriate server-side script include to be called from the client.
g_form	Client-side API object used to manipulate form fields.
g_user	Client-side API object containing information about the current user.
g_scratchpad	Object used to pass server-prepared information to the client, commonly through display business rules.

4. 4. Server-side Development & Scripting

Term	Meaning
Server-side script	JavaScript executed on the ServiceNow server.

Term	Meaning
Client-side script	JavaScript executed in the user's browser.
Business Rule	Server-side logic that runs when specified database events or conditions occur.
Before Business Rule	Business rule that runs before a database operation is committed.
After Business Rule	Business rule that runs after a database operation occurs.
Async Business Rule	Business rule scheduled to run asynchronously after the triggering transaction.
Display Business Rule	Business rule that prepares server-side data for a form before it is displayed.
Query Business Rule	Business rule that can restrict records returned by a query.
Script Include	Reusable server-side JavaScript class or function.
GlideRecord	Server-side API used to query, insert, update, and delete records.
GlideAggregate	Server-side API used for aggregate database queries such as count, sum, min, and max.
GlideQuery	Modern server-side query API for building database queries.
GlideDateTime	API used to work with date and time values.
GlideDate	API used for date values.
GlideTime	API used for time-duration values.
GlideSystem	Server-side API exposed through the gs object for system operations and utilities.
gs	Common shorthand object for GlideSystem.
GlideUser	API for retrieving information about users.
GlideElement	API representing a field/element on a GlideRecord.
GlideAjax	Client-to-server mechanism for calling client-callable Script Includes.
current	The GlideRecord representing the record currently being processed in many server-side contexts.
previous	The prior version of a record available in certain business-rule contexts.
insert()	GlideRecord operation that creates a new record.
update()	GlideRecord operation that saves changes to an existing record.
deleteRecord()	GlideRecord operation that deletes the current record.
query()	GlideRecord operation that executes a database query.
next()	GlideRecord operation that moves to the next record returned by a query.
get()	GlideRecord operation commonly used to retrieve a record by sys_id or field/value.
addQuery()	GlideRecord method used to add query conditions.
addEncodedQuery()	GlideRecord method used to add an encoded query.
orderBy()	GlideRecord method that sorts query results ascending by a field.
orderByDesc()	GlideRecord method that sorts query results descending by a field.
setLimit()	GlideRecord method that limits the number of returned records.
setValue()	GlideRecord method that sets a field value.
getValue()	GlideRecord method that retrieves a field's underlying value.
getDisplayValue()	GlideRecord method that retrieves a field's display value.
initialize()	Prepares a GlideRecord for creating a new record.
addInfoMessage()	Displays an informational message to the user in supported contexts.
addErrorMessage()	Displays an error message to the user in supported contexts.
gs.info()	Writes an informational message to the system log.
gs.error()	Writes an error message to the system log.
gs.warn()	Writes a warning message to the system log.
abort action	A mechanism used in certain server-side contexts to stop a database action.

Term	Meaning
setAbortAction()	Server-side method commonly used to prevent a database action from completing.
setWorkflow()	GlideRecord method that controls workflow/business-rule processing in supported contexts.
autoSysFields()	GlideRecord method that controls automatic system field updates in supported contexts.

5. 5. Security & Access Control

Term	Meaning
Security	The collection of controls that determine who can access data and functionality.
User	A person or account that can log in or be represented in ServiceNow.
Group	A collection of users used for assignment, access, approvals, and administration.
Role	A named permission that grants access to functionality or data.
ACL	Access Control List; rules that determine whether users can perform operations on data.
Table ACL	ACL that applies to a table and operation.
Field ACL	ACL that controls access to a specific field.
Record ACL	ACL behavior applied to individual records based on conditions and scripts.
Read ACL	Controls whether a user can read data.
Write ACL	Controls whether a user can modify data.
Create ACL	Controls whether a user can create records.
Delete ACL	Controls whether a user can delete records.
Execute ACL	Controls whether a user can execute a protected operation or resource.
Condition	A declarative rule that must evaluate true for a configuration to apply.
Scripted ACL	ACL containing server-side script logic.
Role inheritance	A role relationship where one role inherits permissions from another.
Impersonation	Temporarily using the platform as another user for troubleshooting or testing.
Elevated privilege	A temporary higher-level privilege used for certain administrative activities.
Application access	Settings controlling how a table or application can be accessed across scopes.
Cross-scope access	Controlled access between different application scopes.
Isolate script	A security setting that restricts script access to certain APIs or objects in appropriate contexts.
User criteria	Rules that determine which users or groups can access catalog or knowledge content.
Data filtration	Controls used to limit what records or information a user can see.

6. 6. ITSM

Term	Meaning
ITSM	IT Service Management; practices and processes for managing IT services.
Incident Management	Process for restoring normal service operation and minimizing impact after interruptions.
Incident	An unplanned interruption or reduction in quality of an IT service.
Major Incident	An incident with significant business impact requiring coordinated response.
Problem Management	Process for identifying and managing underlying causes of incidents.
Problem	The underlying cause or potential cause of one or more incidents.
Known Error	A problem that has been analyzed and has a documented cause and/or workaround.
Workaround	A temporary method for reducing or avoiding the impact of an issue.
Root Cause	The fundamental reason an incident or problem occurred.

Term	Meaning
Change Management	Process for controlling changes to services and infrastructure.
Change Request	A record used to plan, assess, approve, implement, and review a change.
Normal Change	A change that follows the organization's standard assessment and approval process.
Standard Change	A pre-authorized, low-risk, repeatable change with a defined procedure.
Emergency Change	A change handled through an expedited process because delay could cause significant impact.
Change Advisory Board	Group responsible for reviewing and advising on changes.
CAB	Abbreviation for Change Advisory Board.
Change approval	Authorization required before a change can proceed.
Change conflict	Potential overlap or collision between planned changes.
Change calendar	Calendar showing scheduled changes.
Request Management	Process for handling user requests for services or information.
Service Request	A user request for a standard service or assistance.
Service Catalog	Self-service interface and capability for requesting services.
Knowledge Management	Process of creating, maintaining, and sharing useful knowledge.
Knowledge Base	Collection of knowledge articles.
Knowledge Article	A documented piece of information, procedure, solution, or guidance.
SLA	Service Level Agreement; an agreement defining service commitments and targets.
SLA Definition	Configuration defining how an SLA starts, pauses, resumes, and ends.
Task SLA	A runtime SLA record attached to a task.
SLA condition	Condition determining when an SLA starts, pauses, resumes, or stops.
OLA	Operational Level Agreement; an internal agreement supporting service commitments.
UC	Underpinning Contract; an external supplier agreement supporting service delivery.
Assignment Group	Group responsible for working on an assigned task.
Assignee	Individual user responsible for working on a task.
Caller	User who reports an incident.
Affected user	User impacted by an incident or service issue.
Priority	Relative importance used to help determine handling order.
Impact	Extent of business or service effect caused by an issue.
Urgency	How quickly action is needed.
State	Current lifecycle status of a record.
Work notes	Internal journal entries used for technician/agent communication.
Additional comments	User/customer-facing journal communication in appropriate processes.

7. 7. Service Catalog

Term	Meaning
Catalog Item	An item that a user can request through the Service Catalog.
Record Producer	A catalog item that creates a record in a target table.
Order Guide	A catalog mechanism that lets users request multiple catalog items together.
Variable	An input field presented to a user on a catalog item.
Variable Set	A reusable group of catalog variables.
Single-row variable set	A variable set designed to collect one structured row of information.
Multi-row variable set	A variable set that lets users enter multiple rows of structured information.

Term	Meaning
Catalog Client Script	Client-side script controlling catalog form behavior.
Catalog UI Policy	Declarative rule controlling catalog variable behavior.
Catalog category	A grouping used to organize catalog items.
Catalog homepage	Entry page for browsing and requesting catalog offerings.
Request	The overall request created when a user orders catalog items.
REQ	Common abbreviation for a request record.
Requested Item	A specific catalog item ordered within a request.
RITM	Common abbreviation for Requested Item.
Catalog Task	A task used to fulfill a requested item.
SCTASK	Common abbreviation for Catalog Task.
Approval	A decision/authorization step in a request process.
Fulfillment	The work performed to deliver the requested service or item.
Cart	Temporary collection of catalog items before submission.
User criteria	Rules determining who can see or order catalog content.
Catalog item producer	Another term often used for a record producer.

8. 8. Workflow, Flow Designer & Automation

Term	Meaning
Workflow	An automated sequence of activities that moves work through a process.
Workflow Editor	Classic tool used to create and manage workflows.
Flow Designer	Low-code environment for creating process automation.
Flow	An automation consisting of a trigger and one or more actions.
Trigger	The event or condition that starts a flow.
Action	An operation performed by a flow.
Subflow	A reusable automation component that can be called by flows or other automations.
Flow variable	A value used within a flow to pass or store information.
Data pill	A dynamic value from a trigger or action that can be used later in a flow.
Flow context	Execution information for a particular flow run.
Flow execution	One runtime execution of a flow.
IntegrationHub	ServiceNow capability for building integrations and reusable spokes/actions.
Spoke	A packaged set of integration actions and flows for a particular system or capability.
Action designer	Tool for building reusable actions used by Flow Designer.
Decision	A flow step that chooses a path based on conditions.
Approval action	Flow action used to request or manage an approval.
Wait condition	Flow behavior that pauses until a condition is satisfied.
Scheduled trigger	A flow trigger based on a time schedule.
Event	A named system occurrence that can trigger processing or notifications.
Event queue	System mechanism for queuing events for asynchronous processing.
Event Registry	Configuration defining events known to the platform.
Scheduled Script Execution	A server-side script configured to run on a schedule.
Job	A scheduled or background execution unit.

9. 9. Notifications & Messaging

Term	Meaning
Notification	A configured message sent to users through supported channels.
Email notification	Notification delivered through email.
Email template	Reusable content/layout for emails.
Notification trigger	Event, condition, or action that causes a notification to be generated.
Email script	Server-side script used to dynamically generate notification content.
Inbound Email Action	Logic that processes incoming emails and can create/update records.
Outbound email	Email sent from ServiceNow to recipients.
Inbound email	Email received by ServiceNow for processing.
Event-based notification	Notification generated when a registered event is fired.
Recipient	User, group, or address receiving a notification.
Subscription	A user's configured interest in receiving certain information or updates.

10. 10. Data Import & Migration

Term	Meaning
Import Set	Staging mechanism used to bring external data into ServiceNow before transformation.
Import Set Table	Temporary table that receives imported source data.
Data Source	Definition describing where imported data comes from.
Transform Map	Mapping configuration that moves and transforms source data into a target table.
Transform Script	Script used during an import transformation.
Source field	Field in the imported source data.
Target field	Field in the ServiceNow destination table.
Coalesce	Import setting used to identify existing target records for update instead of creating duplicates.
Transform event	A point in the import process where transformation logic can execute.
Import Set Run	A particular execution of an import set.
Import Set Row	An individual imported source row.
Import Set Log	Information about an import execution and its results.
Data Loader	A mechanism/tool for loading structured data into ServiceNow.
Data migration	Moving data from one system or environment to another.
Data cleansing	Identifying and correcting invalid, incomplete, or duplicate data.
Duplicate	Two or more records representing the same real-world entity.
Coalesce field	A source field used by a transform map to identify a matching target record.

11. 11. Integration & APIs

Term	Meaning
Integration	A connection that allows ServiceNow to exchange data or trigger actions with another system.
API	Application Programming Interface; a defined way for software systems to communicate.
REST	HTTP-based architectural style commonly used for APIs.
REST API	API interface used to exchange resources over HTTP.
REST Message	ServiceNow configuration for calling an external REST endpoint.

Term	Meaning
SOAP	Web-service protocol based on XML messaging.
SOAP Message	ServiceNow configuration for making SOAP web-service calls.
Scripted REST API	Custom REST API built using ServiceNow resources and server-side scripts.
Scripted SOAP Web Service	Custom SOAP web service implemented in ServiceNow.
Table API	REST API that provides CRUD access to table records.
Import Set API	API used to load data into import set tables.
Attachment API	API used to work with record attachments.
Aggregate API	API or interface used for aggregate data operations where supported.
OAuth	Authorization framework used to grant delegated API access.
OAuth profile	Configuration containing OAuth-related integration settings.
Credential	Stored authentication information used by an integration.
Connection	Configured endpoint/authentication information used by an integration.
MID Server	ServiceNow server component used to communicate with systems inside a private network.
ECC Queue	Internal messaging/communication queue used for MID Server and related processing.
IntegrationHub spoke	Packaged integration capability containing reusable actions.
Web service	A service interface that allows systems to communicate over a network.
Endpoint	A URL or interface where an API or service can be accessed.
HTTP method	Request operation such as GET, POST, PUT, PATCH, or DELETE.
GET	HTTP method commonly used to retrieve data.
POST	HTTP method commonly used to create or submit data.
PUT	HTTP method commonly used to replace/update a resource.
PATCH	HTTP method commonly used to partially update a resource.
DELETE	HTTP method commonly used to delete a resource.
Payload	Data sent in an API request or response.
JSON	Text-based data format widely used by REST APIs.
XML	Markup-based data format used by many integrations and legacy web services.

12. 12. CMDB, CSDM & ITOM

Term	Meaning
CMDB	Configuration Management Database; repository for configuration items and their relationships.
Configuration Item	An entity managed as part of configuration management, such as a server, application, or network device.
CI	Abbreviation for Configuration Item.
CI class	Category/type of configuration item in the CMDB hierarchy.
CI relationship	A defined relationship between two configuration items.
Relationship type	Defines how two CIs are related, such as runs on or depends on.
Relationship map	Visual representation of CI relationships.
CMDB Health	Capabilities and metrics used to assess CMDB data quality and completeness.
Duplicate CI	Multiple CMDB records representing the same real-world configuration item.
Stale CI	A CI whose information is no longer current or whose existence may no longer be valid.
Identification	Process of determining whether incoming data represents an existing CI.
Reconciliation	Process of deciding which data source is allowed to update particular CI attributes.

Term	Meaning
IRE	Identification and Reconciliation Engine used to identify CIs and reconcile source data.
Data source	Origin of CI or asset data, such as Discovery or an integration.
Discovery	ServiceNow capability that discovers infrastructure and populates CMDB data.
Discovery schedule	Configuration controlling when and where discovery runs.
Pattern	Discovery logic used to identify and classify infrastructure components.
Horizontal discovery	Discovery approach that identifies infrastructure components and their relationships.
Service Mapping	Capability that maps dependencies between applications/services and infrastructure.
Application Service	A logical service representation used to model an application and its supporting infrastructure.
Service Graph	Framework and integrations for bringing trusted service/CI data into the CMDB.
Service Graph Connector	Certified connector that imports third-party data into the CMDB following Service Graph practices.
ITOM	IT Operations Management; capabilities for visibility, health, and operational management.
Event Management	Capability for processing operational events and creating/associating alerts and incidents.
Event	Operational signal received from a monitoring source.
Alert	Normalized operational event that may require attention.
Alert correlation	Process of grouping related alerts to reduce noise and identify a meaningful issue.
Health Log Analytics	Capabilities for analyzing operational logs and telemetry where licensed.
AIOps	Use of AI/analytics to improve IT operations, event handling, and incident response.
CSDM	Common Service Data Model; standardized service-related terms, relationships, and data-model guidance across ServiceNow.
CSDM domain	A defined area of the CSDM model used to organize service and related data.
Business Service	A service viewed from the business/customer perspective.
Technical Service	A technology-oriented service supporting business or other services.
Service Offering	A specific offering or level of a service that can be consumed.
Business Service Offering	A service offering associated with a business service.
Technical Service Offering	An offering associated with a technical service.
Business Application	A logical application used by a business function or organization.
Application Service	A service representation of an application in operation.
Service Owner	Person accountable for a service.
Service Portfolio	Collection of services managed across their lifecycle.
Service Catalog	Published set of requestable services or offerings.

13. 13. IT Asset Management

Term	Meaning
ITAM	IT Asset Management; managing IT assets through their lifecycle.
Asset	A physical or logical item that has financial, contractual, operational, or ownership significance.
Hardware Asset	Physical IT equipment such as laptops, servers, monitors, or network devices.
Software Asset	Software entitlement or software-related asset information.
Asset lifecycle	Stages an asset passes through from acquisition to retirement.
Asset repository	Data store used to manage asset records.
Asset class	Classification of an asset.
Asset tag	Identifier physically or logically assigned to an asset.

Term	Meaning
Model	A definition representing a type of product or equipment.
Model category	Grouping used to classify models.
Model record	Record describing a particular product/model.
Vendor	Organization that supplies a product, service, or asset.
Contract	Agreement containing commercial or service terms.
Lease	Contract arrangement in which an asset is used for a defined period under lease terms.
Warranty	Coverage provided by a manufacturer or supplier for a product.
Entitlement	Rights granted under a contract or software license.
License	Legal permission to use software under defined terms.
Software entitlement	Record representing the organization's rights to use software.
HAM	Hardware Asset Management.
SAM	Software Asset Management.
Asset-to-CI relationship	Association connecting an asset record with a configuration item.

14. 14. Knowledge & Content

Term	Meaning
Knowledge Management	Practice of creating, organizing, maintaining, and sharing knowledge.
Knowledge Base	Container for knowledge articles and related configuration.
Knowledge Article	A reusable piece of documented knowledge.
Article template	Predefined structure for creating knowledge articles.
Knowledge workflow	Approval and lifecycle process for knowledge content.
Knowledge feedback	User feedback about the usefulness or quality of an article.
Knowledge ownership	Responsibility for maintaining a knowledge base or article.
Knowledge domain	Security or organizational boundary used to organize knowledge.
Article version	A particular revision of a knowledge article.
Publish	Make approved knowledge content available to intended users.
Retire	Remove an article from active use while retaining it according to policy.
Knowledge search	Search capability for finding relevant knowledge content.

15. 15. Reporting & Analytics

Term	Meaning
Report	A configurable presentation of ServiceNow data for analysis or monitoring.
Dashboard	A page containing multiple reports, visualizations, or widgets.
Homepage	A configurable landing page in classic ServiceNow experiences.
Performance Analytics	Capabilities for tracking KPIs, trends, targets, and performance over time.
KPI	Key Performance Indicator; a measurable value used to track performance.
Indicator	A defined metric used in Performance Analytics.
Indicator source	Definition describing the data used to calculate an indicator.
Data collector	Scheduled process that collects indicator data.
Breakdown	Dimension used to segment indicator results.
Breakdown source	Definition that supplies values used for a breakdown.

Term	Meaning
Scorecard	A view of performance indicator values and trends.
Target	Desired or benchmark value for an indicator.
Threshold	Defined value used to determine performance bands or conditions.
Trend	Direction of a metric over time.
Analytics hub	Experience for analyzing and exploring analytics data where available.
Visualization	Graphical representation of data.
PA widget	Performance Analytics visualization placed on a dashboard.

16. 16. Update Sets & Deployment

Term	Meaning
Update Set	A collection of configuration changes that can be transferred between instances.
Local Update Set	An update set created and captured in the current instance.
Retrieved Update Set	An update set imported from another instance.
Update Set Preview	Validation step that identifies conflicts or issues before commit.
Update Set Commit	Action that applies an update set's captured changes to the target instance.
Preview problem	Issue identified during update-set preview.
Update Set collision	Situation where a change conflicts with another version of the same artifact.
Captured update	Configuration change recorded in an update set.
Application file	A configuration artifact that can be packaged or moved as part of application development.
Source control	Mechanism for integrating application development with source-code repositories.
Branch	A separate line of source-control development.
Commit	A source-control operation that records a set of changes.
Clone	Process of copying instance data/configuration to another environment under supported cloning rules.
Deployment	Moving approved application/configuration changes into a target environment.
Promotion	Moving a change from one development stage to another.
Pipeline	A repeatable sequence for validating and deploying application changes.

17. 17. ServiceNow Architecture & System Concepts

Term	Meaning
System property	Configurable key/value setting that changes platform behavior.
System dictionary	Metadata repository describing tables and fields.
System table	Internal ServiceNow table storing platform configuration or metadata.
sys_db_object	System table commonly associated with table definitions.
sys_dictionary	System table containing dictionary metadata.
sys_user	System table containing user records.
sys_user_group	System table containing group records.
sys_user_has_role	Relationship table connecting users and roles.
sys_group_has_role	Relationship table connecting groups and roles.
sys_journal_field	System table storing journal field entries.
sys_attachment	System table storing attachment metadata.

Term	Meaning
sys_attachment_doc	System table storing attachment data chunks.
sys_audit	System table storing audited field changes where auditing is enabled.
Audit	Tracking of changes made to selected records or fields.
Audit history	Historical record of audited changes.
System log	Platform log containing messages generated by system processes and scripts.
Transaction log	Information about request/transaction processing used for diagnostics.
Debugging	Finding and correcting problems in scripts or configuration.
Script debugger	Tool for stepping through supported server-side scripts.
Debug log	Diagnostic output used to understand script or platform behavior.
Node	A server process participating in the ServiceNow instance.
Cluster	A group of ServiceNow nodes working together.
Cache	Stored information used to improve performance or reduce repeated processing.
Cache flush	Operation that clears selected cached information.
Session	A user's active interaction context with the instance.
Transaction	A unit of request processing handled by the platform.
Asynchronous processing	Work executed outside the immediate user transaction.
Synchronous processing	Work completed within the current request/transaction.

18. 18. Service Portal & Employee Experience

Term	Meaning
Service Portal	Web-based self-service experience built on ServiceNow portal technology.
Portal	A user-facing web experience for accessing ServiceNow content and services.
Widget	Reusable Service Portal UI component containing client, server, HTML, and styling logic.
Widget instance	A configured occurrence of a widget on a portal page.
Portal page	A page in Service Portal containing widgets.
Page route	The path used to access a portal page.
Service Portal theme	Visual styling and layout configuration for a portal.
Employee Center	Modern employee-facing self-service experience.
Employee Center Pro	Expanded Employee Center capabilities for richer employee experiences.
Topic	A content/category area used to organize employee self-service information.
Content item	A piece of content exposed through an employee experience.
Mega menu	Expanded navigation menu used in some ServiceNow experiences.
Knowledge search	Search experience for finding relevant articles.

19. 19. Customer Service Management

Term	Meaning
CSM	Customer Service Management; ServiceNow capabilities for managing customer interactions and service cases.
Customer	An external or internal party receiving a service, depending on the CSM model.
Account	An organization represented as a customer or partner account.
Contact	A person associated with an account.

Term	Meaning
Consumer	An individual customer in consumer-oriented service scenarios.
Case	A CSM work record used to manage customer issues or requests.
Case type	Classification defining the kind of customer case.
Case assignment	Process of routing a case to the appropriate agent/group.
Case management	End-to-end handling of customer cases.
Customer portal	Customer-facing interface for self-service and case interactions.
Customer community	Community experience where customers can access knowledge and services.
Entitlement	Rule or agreement determining a customer's service rights or support coverage.
Install base	Representation of products or services owned/used by a customer.
Sold product	A product/service instance sold to a customer.
Consumer service	Service provided to an individual consumer.
Advanced Work Assignment	Capability for routing work to agents based on defined criteria and availability.
Omnichannel	Handling work across multiple interaction channels in a unified experience.

20. 20. HR Service Delivery

Term	Meaning
HRSD	HR Service Delivery; ServiceNow capabilities for employee HR services.
HR case	Record used to manage an employee HR request or issue.
HR service	A service or process provided by HR.
Employee Center	Self-service experience commonly used by employees to access HR services.
HR criteria	Rules controlling HR content/service access.
HR profile	Record containing relevant employee HR information.
HR lifecycle event	A process triggered by an employee lifecycle event such as joining or leaving.
Lifecycle event	A coordinated set of activities associated with an employee event.
COE	Center of Excellence; HR service area grouping related HR services.
HR case template	Reusable configuration for creating HR cases.
HR knowledge	Knowledge content supporting employee HR self-service.

21. 21. Security Operations & GRC

Term	Meaning
SecOps	Security Operations capabilities for managing security incidents, vulnerabilities, and response.
Security Incident	A security-related event requiring investigation or response.
Vulnerability	A weakness that could be exploited to cause harm.
Vulnerability Response	Process/capability for identifying and remediating vulnerabilities.
Threat	A potential cause of harm to systems, data, or services.
Security incident response	Activities used to investigate, contain, and resolve security incidents.
GRC	Governance, Risk, and Compliance.
Risk	Potential for an event or condition to affect objectives.
Risk statement	Structured description of a risk scenario.
Control	A policy, procedure, or measure designed to manage risk.
Compliance	Conformance with policies, standards, regulations, or requirements.

Term	Meaning
Audit engagement	Structured activity used to evaluate compliance or controls.
Policy	Formal organizational requirement or rule.
Authority document	Source defining an external or internal compliance requirement.

22. 22. Project & Portfolio Management

Term	Meaning
PPM	Project Portfolio Management.
Project	Temporary work organized to achieve defined objectives.
Project task	Task associated with a project.
Demand	Proposed work that can be evaluated before becoming a project.
Idea	Early-stage suggestion for potential work or investment.
Portfolio	Collection of related investments, projects, or services.
Program	Group of related projects managed together.
Resource	Person, skill, or capacity used to perform work.
Resource plan	Plan describing required resource capacity.
Time card	Record of time spent on work.
Cost plan	Plan describing expected project or investment costs.
Benefit plan	Plan describing expected business benefits.
Roadmap	High-level timeline of planned initiatives or capabilities.

23. 23. Common Abbreviations

Term	Meaning
ITIL	Information Technology Infrastructure Library; a widely used framework for IT service management practices.
ITOM	IT Operations Management.
ITSM	IT Service Management.
ITAM	IT Asset Management.
CSM	Customer Service Management.
HRSD	HR Service Delivery.
GRC	Governance, Risk, and Compliance.
IRM	Integrated Risk Management.
SecOps	Security Operations.
CMDB	Configuration Management Database.
CSDM	Common Service Data Model.
CI	Configuration Item.
SLA	Service Level Agreement.
OLA	Operational Level Agreement.
UC	Underpinning Contract.
CAB	Change Advisory Board.
RCA	Root Cause Analysis.
KPI	Key Performance Indicator.

Term	Meaning
PA	Performance Analytics.
PDI	Personal Developer Instance.
OOTB	Out of the box.
ACL	Access Control List.
API	Application Programming Interface.
REST	Representational State Transfer.
SOAP	Simple Object Access Protocol.
JSON	JavaScript Object Notation.
XML	Extensible Markup Language.
CRUD	Create, Read, Update, Delete.
MID	Management, Instrumentation, and Discovery; commonly referring to the MID Server component.
IRE	Identification and Reconciliation Engine.
HAM	Hardware Asset Management.
SAM	Software Asset Management.
PPM	Project Portfolio Management.
UI	User Interface.
UX	User Experience.
M2M	Many-to-many.
REQ	Request record abbreviation.
RITM	Requested Item abbreviation.
SCTASK	Catalog Task abbreviation.

24. 24. Important System Objects & Tables

Term	Meaning
sys_id	Unique identifier for a record.
sys_created_on	System field storing record creation date/time.
sys_created_by	System field storing the user who created the record.
sys_updated_on	System field storing the latest update date/time.
sys_updated_by	System field storing the user who last updated the record.
sys_mod_count	System field storing the number of updates made to a record.
sys_class_name	Field identifying the class/table of a record in an inheritance hierarchy.
sys_domain	Field used in domain-separated environments.
sys_domain_path	Field representing domain hierarchy/path.
sys_tags	System field/feature for record tagging where enabled.
sys_attachment	Table containing attachment metadata.
sys_properties	Table storing system properties.
sys_dictionary	Table storing field/table metadata.
sys_db_object	Table storing table definitions.
sys_script	Table associated with Business Rules.
sys_script_include	Table associated with Script Includes.
sys_ui_policy	Table associated with UI Policies.
sys_ui_action	Table associated with UI Actions.

Term	Meaning
sys_ui_script	Table associated with UI Scripts.
sys_ui_page	Table associated with UI Pages.
sys_security_acl	Table associated with ACL definitions.
sys_user	Table containing users.
sys_user_group	Table containing groups.
sys_user_has_role	Table representing user-role relationships.
sys_group_has_role	Table representing group-role relationships.
sys_choice	Table storing choice definitions.
sys_dictionary_override	Table used for dictionary overrides on extended tables.
sys_relationship	Table defining relationships used by related lists.
sys_m2m	Table/configuration for many-to-many definitions.
sys_update_xml	Table associated with update-set captured changes.
sys_email	Table containing email records.
syslog	System log table/record source used for system messages.

Recommended Learning Order

1. Platform basics → Instance → Application → Module → Table → Record → Field → Form → List
2. Data model → References → Dot-walking → Table extension → Dictionary → Related lists
3. Administration → Users → Groups → Roles → ACLs → Lists/forms → Import Sets
4. ITSM → Incident → Problem → Change → Request → Knowledge → SLA
5. Development → Client Scripts → UI Policies → Business Rules → Script Includes → GlideRecord → GlideAjax
6. Automation → Flow Designer → Triggers → Actions → Subflows → IntegrationHub
7. CMDB/CSDM → CI → Relationships → Discovery → IRE → Service Mapping → Services and offerings
8. Integration → REST → SOAP → APIs → OAuth → MID Server → ECC Queue
9. Advanced areas → ITAM → CSM → HRSD → SecOps/GRC → PPM → Performance Analytics

Reference basis: ServiceNow's official Now Platform glossary, Now Platform reference material, and official ServiceNow product documentation were used to validate terminology and concepts. Product-specific definitions can vary by release and licensed application.

Official reference: ServiceNow Now Platform Glossary and ServiceNow Now Platform Reference Guide.